BIHAR: TEJASWI YADAV'S QUOTA GAMBIT PG 9

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SEEKING ABSOLUTION Sukhbir Singh Badal serving his religious punishment at the Golden Temple in Amritsar, Dec. 4

PRABHJOT GILL

PUNJAB/ AKALI DAL

SUKHBIR'S MOMENT OF RECKONING

By Anilesh S. Mahajan

On December 4, amidst the solemnity of his *sewa* duties at the Golden Temple in Amritsar, Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) leader Sukhbir Singh Badal had an unexpected brush with danger. A former Khalistani terrorist, Narain Singh Chaura, opened fire at the entrance of the holiest of Sikh shrines where a wheelchair-bound Sukhbir (he has a fractured leg), clad in the blue *sewadar* uniform and holding a spear, was serving as a guard. The swift intervention of onlookers thwarted the attack, and Chaura was overpowered and handed over to the police.

Sukhbir had been stationed at the Golden Temple as part of his *tankha*—punishment for religious